Different colour combinations

Black + red

How it feels

Strength and fire. Red gives black life and black gives red depth. Together they look like glowing coals.

When it suits

When you want **expression and courage**.

Specific shades



black + red
strikingly



charcoal + burgundy
deeply



anthracite + coral
dramatically



ink black + scarlet
provocatively



soot + brick
subduedly

In practice

A black jacket and red lipstick. A black wall and a red picture.

Watch out

Two strong colours tend to be loud. Add **white or cream**.

Black + orange

How it feels

Night and fire. Orange warms black up and black calms orange. Together they look modern and playful.

When it suits

When you want **warmth with distance**.

Specific shades



black + orange
radiantly



charcoal + terracotta
richly



anthracite + apricot
playfully



ink black + pumpkin
daringly



soot + rust
earthily

In practice

A black sofa with an orange cushion. A black bag and an orange scarf.

Watch out

Too much orange next to black shouts. Try to **mute it with something earthier**.

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Black + yellow

How it feels

Night and light. Yellow lights black up and black gives yellow expression. Together they look like a warning sign and like a lamp behind a window.

When it suits

When you want **a clear signal**.

Specific shades


black + yellow
cheerfully


charcoal + ochre
golden


anthracite + butter
strikingly


ink black + lemon
radiantly


soot + mustard
subduedly

In practice

A black coat and a yellow scarf. A black wall and a yellow vase.

Watch out

At equal intensity the colours pull against each other. Leave yellow **as an accent**.

Black + green

How it feels

Leaves out of shadow. Green stands out against a black background. Together they look like plants at night.

When it suits

When you want **a natural and deep impression**.

Specific shades


black + green
naturally


charcoal + bottle green
woodland


anthracite + mint
freshly


ink black + emerald
strikingly


soot + sage
quietly

In practice

A green plant in front of a black wall. Bottle green and black in a kitchen.

Watch out

A sharp green next to black sounds loud. **Mute** the green.

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Black + blue

How it feels

Night sky. Blue cools black and black deepens blue. Together they feel calm and serious.

When it suits

When you want **calm and depth**.

Specific shades



black + blue
calmly



charcoal + dark blue
deeply



anthracite + sky
airily



ink black + cobalt
freshly



soot + denim
soberly

In practice

A blue jumper and black trousers. A light blue wall and black furniture.

Watch out

Both tend to be cool. Without warmth the whole can seem **cold**.

Black + indigo

How it feels

Ink. Indigo gives black depth and black gives indigo firmness. Together they look like night with a hint of blue.

When it suits

When you want **depth without heaviness**.

Specific shades



black + indigo
at dusk



charcoal + ink
deeply



anthracite + twilight blue
firmly



ink black + ultramarine
dramatically



soot + grey-indigo
soberly

In practice

An indigo coat and black shoes. Navy and black in an office.

Watch out

Dark and dark blend. Add **a light colour**.

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Black + violet

How it feels

Night and mystery. Purple gives black dreaminess and black gives purple firmness. Together they feel sensual and mysterious.

When it suits

When you want **sensuality and depth**.

Specific shades


black + purple
dreamily


charcoal + plum
mysteriously


anthracite + lavender
deeply


ink black + orchid
richly


soot + grey-violet
dustily

In practice

Plum and black in a dress. Purple jewellery on a black jumper.

Watch out

Too much darkness and purple can feel heavy. Add **a light colour**.

Black + pink

How it feels

Hardness and softness. Pink softens black and black sets off pink. Together they look modern and a little rebellious.

When it suits

When you want **expression and softness**.

Specific shades


black + pink
modernly


charcoal + raspberry
dramatically


anthracite + powder
gently


ink black + fuchsia
provocatively


soot + old rose
discreetly

In practice

A black jacket and a pink shirt. A blackboard and pink chalk.

Watch out

Two strong colours tend to be loud. Add **white**.

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Black + grey

How it feels

Elegance. Grey softens black and black deepens grey. Together they look tasteful and sober.

When it suits

When you want **elegance without shouting**.

Specific shades



black + grey
soberly



charcoal + graphite
elegantly



anthracite + silver
lightly



ink black + slate
modernly



soot + dove
quietly

In practice

A black jacket and a grey jumper. A blackboard and grey chalk.

Watch out

Two dark colours tend to be heavy. Add **a light element**.

Black + brown

How it feels

Earth and night. Brown warms black and black deepens brown. Together they look serious, but with warmth.

When it suits

When you want **depth and nature**.

Specific shades



black + brown
dramatically



charcoal + chocolate
deeply



anthracite + beige
soberly



ink black + caramel
elegantly



soot + linen
discreetly

In practice

A black jacket and brown boots. A black kitchen unit and a wooden worktop.

Watch out

Two dark colours tend to be heavy. Add **white or cream**.

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Black + white

How it feels

Chessboard. White brightens black and black sets off white. Together they look clear and graphic.

When it suits

When you want **clear contrast**.

Specific shades



black + white
cleanly



charcoal + ivory
elegantly



anthracite + snow
graphically



ink black + milk
strikingly



soot + bone
soberly

In practice

A black-and-white photograph. A white shirt and a black jacket.

Watch out

With small patterns the contrast can be distracting. Add **one calm area**.

Black + gold

How it feels

Celebration. Gold highlights black and gives it shine. Together they look festive and luxurious.

When it suits

When you want **celebration with depth**.

Specific shades



black + gold
festively



charcoal + antique gold
richly



anthracite + champagne
gently



ink black + rich gold
radiantly



soot + matte gold
subduedly

In practice

Gold jewellery on a black dress. Black packaging with gold lettering.

Watch out

In excess gold drowns out calm and the space recalls **a shop window**.

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A SIMPLE RULE

- When you want to **soften** black, add **cream**, **grey**, **wood** or **linen**.
- When you want to **bring it to life**, add **green**, **yellow** or **pink**.
- When you want to **deepen** it, **indigo**, **dark blue** or **purple** will help.
- When you want to **emphasise** it, add **white**, **gold** or **red**.

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